STATE SCAN

UP: FREED, KHAN IS ON A POLITICAL HUNT *PG 18*

KERALA: WHEELS WITHIN DEALS *PG 22*



ANI

HOME ALONE Cops at the Chandigarh residence of IPS officer Y. Puran Kumar (inset)



HARYANA

DOUBLE SUICIDE MUDDLE

Two dead cops. Two smoking guns with varying signals. A sordid tale of caste bias and low intrigue unravels among Haryana's top police brass. The stain spreads to society, politics

By **Anilesh S. Mahajan**

IPS OFFICER Y. PURAN KUMAR wrote his last letter, and sealed it with a bullet—his service pistol turned on himself, on October 7, in his Chandigarh home. That guaranteed his words ricocheted through Haryana's police establishment, bureaucracy and polity, gaining an amplitude his voice was denied while he lived and spoke. In his eight-page 'final note', the Dalit officer detailed years of harassment, humiliation and derailing of his career by seniors.

In short, another iteration of a shockingly familiar tale. At least that's what it looked like till a most bizarre twist was sprung on the plot. On October 14, Sandeep Lather, an Assistant Sub-Inspector in the team probing the suicide, also ended his life, this time with the darkest invective against Kumar!

A COUNTER-SUICIDE

In a video, and in a four-page suicide note, Lather switched around the villains and heroes of Kumar's story—his incriminatory words, alleging corruption and caste bias, were all against the late IPS officer and his IAS officer-wife Amneet